

COMPANION DIGITAL PACKAGE

Who to Follow in Identity Security

The thought leaders, communities, and voices shaping the field

Top 50 identity thought leaders globally — who they are and why they matter 12 communities, podcasts, and platforms to join today

Mastering Identity Security for CIDPro™
Abbas Kudrati | 2026 Edition

50
Thought Leaders

12
Communities

Global
Coverage

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APPENDIX E

Who to Follow in the Identity Industry

Top 50 Identity Professionals, Evangelists, and Thought Leaders Shaping the Future of Digital Identity

CIDPro™ Exam Prep Book

Introduction

The identity and access management profession is shaped by a vibrant community of practitioners, researchers, analysts, standards architects, and evangelists who generously share their knowledge, challenge conventional thinking, and drive the industry forward. Following these thought leaders is one of the most effective ways to stay current with emerging threats, evolving standards, and real-world best practices.

This appendix presents fifty identity professionals worth following, listed in alphabetical order by surname. The list draws from multiple sources including the NHI Management Group's Top 20 Identity Evangelists (nhimg.org), the IDPro community, KuppingerCole and Gartner analyst networks, The Identity Underground, the Identity Management Institute, podcast hosts, and active practitioners who consistently contribute to the profession through writing, speaking, and open-source development.

Each entry includes a brief introduction and a LinkedIn profile link. We encourage you to follow these professionals, engage with their content, and contribute your own voice to the identity community.

Note: *This list was curated at the time of publication and represents a cross-section of the global identity community. Many other outstanding professionals contribute daily to this field. If you are not on this list, keep sharing your knowledge—the identity community grows stronger with every voice.*

Top 50 Identity Professionals and Thought Leaders

Listed in alphabetical order by first name.

#	Name	Introduction	LinkedIn Profile
1	Abbas Kudrati	Chief Identity Security & AI Advisor at Silverfort APJ, former Microsoft Asia Chief Cybersecurity Advisor, best-selling author, Professor of Practice at La Trobe University, and global keynote speaker on Zero Trust and identity security.	linkedin.com/in/akudrati
2	Alexandre Blanc	Cybersecurity leader specialising in threat intelligence, risk management, and enterprise defence strategies. A respected voice in the global cyber community promoting practical, people-focused security transformation.	linkedin.com/in/alexandre-blanc-cyber-security
3	Alexei Balaganski	Analyst at KuppingerCole specialising in cybersecurity and AI applications. Covers security topics from database protection to AI-based automation, combining development and infosec expertise.	linkedin.com/in/intelfx
4	Andras Cser	Principal Analyst at Forrester Research covering IAM, fraud management, privileged identity management, and entitlement management. A leading authority on access governance and identity modernisation.	linkedin.com/in/andrascser
5	André Koot	Independent IAM consultant and prolific contributor to the IDPro Body of Knowledge. Expert in access control, non-human account management, and identity governance with decades of enterprise IAM experience.	linkedin.com/in/andrekkoot
6	Andrew Hindle	Digital identity community leader and event organiser, best known for his work with the Internet Identity Workshop and Identiverse. Fosters global collaboration and innovation across the identity ecosystem.	linkedin.com/in/ahindle
7	Atul Tulshibagwale	Co-creator of the Shared Signals Framework (SSF) and Continuous Access Evaluation Protocol (CAEP). Leads efforts to enable real-time security event sharing across identity providers and relying parties.	linkedin.com/in/atuls
8	Chase Cunningham (Dr.)	Known as “Dr. Zero Trust,” a leading cybersecurity strategist and author shaping Zero Trust adoption worldwide. Combines military intelligence expertise with cutting-edge cybersecurity vision.	linkedin.com/in/dr-chase-cunningham
9	Confidence Staveley	Cybersecurity awareness and education leader empowering African communities through the CyberSafe Foundation. One of Africa's most influential voices in global cybersecurity advocacy and digital literacy.	linkedin.com/in/confidencestaveley
10	David Lee	IAM thought leader, strategist, and host of the Identity Jedi podcast. Bridges the technical and human aspects of identity, making innovation relatable and actionable for business leaders.	linkedin.com/in/identityjedi
11	David Mahdi	Digital trust strategist and former Gartner analyst bridging identity, security, and risk management. A prominent voice on digital trust ecosystems, cryptography, and identity verification.	linkedin.com/in/dmahdi
12	Dean H. Saxe	Senior Security Engineer at AWS Identity and founding member of IDPro. Expert in account recovery, FIDO/passkey authentication, and identity resilience. Contributor to the IDPro Body of Knowledge.	linkedin.com/in/deanhsaxe
13	Erik Wahlström	VP Analyst at Gartner specialising in IAM, access control, PKI, identity fabrics, and machine identity. Translates complex identity architectures into actionable enterprise strategies.	linkedin.com/in/erik-wahlström
14	Espen Bago	Original founder of “IdentiBeer” and identity strategist. Author of “Words of Identity,” a guide to clarifying IAM terminology. Bridges technical, policy, and linguistic gaps within the IAM ecosystem.	linkedin.com/in/iamsolutions
15	Eve Maler	Global leader in digital identity, consent, and privacy technology. Co-invented SAML and contributed to OAuth and User-Managed Access (UMA). Advocates for a human-centred, interoperable	linkedin.com/in/evemaler

		identity future.	
16	Felix Gaehtgens	Former senior analyst at Gartner and KuppingerCole specialising in IAM, PAM, machine identity, and security architecture. Translates complex identity concepts into actionable enterprise insights.	linkedin.com/in/felixgaehtgens
17	Francis Odum	Cybersecurity researcher and independent analyst who founded Software Analyst Cybersecurity Research. Focuses on identity, cloud, and application security, and teaches cybersecurity at Maven.	linkedin.com/in/francis-odum
18	Graham Williamson	Senior IAM consultant and co-author of multiple IDPro Body of Knowledge articles covering digital identity lifecycle, non-human identities, and workforce planning. A foundational voice in IAM education.	linkedin.com/in/grahamwilliamson
19	Heather Flanagan	Federation and trust framework expert with deep background in standards and community governance. Has led identity initiatives through REFEDS, IETF, and other global trust communities.	linkedin.com/in/hlflanagan
20	Heiko Klarl	Identity and cybersecurity marketing strategist. Former CMO at iC Consult, helping define the public voice of identity consulting. Champions awareness of identity's central role in digital transformation.	linkedin.com/in/heiko-klarl
21	Helen Yu	Cybersecurity and digital transformation strategist aligning business growth with security resilience. Speaker, author, and advisor empowering leaders to adopt security as a driver of enterprise success.	linkedin.com/in/yuhelenyu
22	Henrique Teixeira	Influential IAM strategist known for advancing CIAM and Zero Trust frameworks. Former Gartner analyst combining analytical depth with practical deployment insights for perimeterless identity strategies.	linkedin.com/in/bernardes
23	Henry Bagdasarian	Founder of the Identity Management Institute (IMI) and creator of CIAM, CIGE, CIMP, and other IMI certifications. Author of "Identity Diet" and a leading voice in identity governance education.	linkedin.com/in/henrybagdasarian
24	Ian Glazer	Leading identity standards pioneer and co-founder of IDPro. Former SVP of Identity Product Management at Salesforce. Drives ethical, interoperable, and privacy-respecting identity ecosystems.	linkedin.com/in/iglazer
25	Jeff Steadman	Co-host of the Identity at the Center (IDAC) podcast exploring digital identity, IAM, and cybersecurity. Bridges identity, cloud, and risk conversations for practitioners and leaders.	linkedin.com/in/jeffsteadman
26	Jesse Minor	Identity governance and risk management professional focused on practical strategies for secure access and compliance. Emphasises measurable outcomes and resilient identity architectures.	linkedin.com/in/jesse-minor
27	Jessica Stone	Managing Director at The Identity Underground, an exclusive global network of CXOs and practitioners focused on identity security innovation. Leads strategic gatherings across Americas, EMEA, and APAC.	linkedin.com/in/jessica-stone-43180016
28	Jim McDonald	Co-host of the Identity at the Center (IDAC) podcast. Decades of hands-on IAM experience translating complex identity-and-access challenges into accessible, business-driven conversations.	linkedin.com/in/jimmcdonaldpmp
29	Justin Richer	Security architect, software engineer, and co-chair of the IETF WIMSE working group. Contributed to OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, G NAP, and HTTP Message Signatures standards.	linkedin.com/in/justinricher
30	Kim Cameron (in memoriam)	Former Chief Identity Architect at Microsoft and author of the "Laws of Identity." A towering influence whose seven principles continue to shape identity architecture globally. His blog remains essential reading.	identityblog.com (legacy)
31	Lalit Choda	Known as "Mr. NHI," founder of the Non-Human Identity Management Group (nhimg.org). Leading evangelist on NHI	linkedin.com/in/lalit-choda

		risks, author of groundbreaking research, and keynote speaker on non-human identities.	
32	Lance Peterman	IAM and cybersecurity expert with deep expertise spanning risk management, cloud security, and mobility. Adjunct Professor at UNC Charlotte. Long-time speaker at Identiverse and RSA Conference.	linkedin.com/in/lancepeterman
33	Malhar Vora	Principal Security Engineer and PAM Engineering Lead at ANZ Bank. CyberArk MVP, conference speaker at AISA and EIC, and member of The Identity Underground. Specialises in PAM, cloud IAM, and identity resilience.	linkedin.com/in/malhar-vora
34	Mark Morowczynski	Principal Program Manager in the Microsoft Identity division. Speaker at Black Hat, DEF CON, and Ignite. Works directly with enterprise customers on Entra ID deployments. Co-founded the AskPFEplat blog.	linkedin.com/in/markmorow
35	Martin Kuppinger	Founder and Principal Analyst at KuppingerCole Analysts. Author of 50+ IT books and a top-10 global expert in identity management and digital identity. Shapes industry thought around IAM and digital trust.	linkedin.com/in/martinkuppinger
36	Martin Sandren	Experienced IAM architect and consultant helping global enterprises build scalable, standards-based identity platforms. Known for technical depth in SSO, federation, and access control.	linkedin.com/in/martinsandren
37	Matthias Reinwarth	Senior IAM analyst, moderator, and podcast host at KuppingerCole. Connects the identity community through research, interviews, and events focused on IAM and cybersecurity.	linkedin.com/in/matthias-reinwarth
38	Mike Kiser	Director of Strategy & Standards at SailPoint focusing on identity governance, privacy, and ethical technology. Frequent speaker at major security conferences and active in industry standards.	linkedin.com/in/mike-kiser
39	Mike Schwartz	Host of Identifierati Office Hours and founder of Gluu, an open-source IAM platform. Longtime advocate of OAuth and OpenID Connect who has democratised access to enterprise-grade IAM.	linkedin.com/in/nynymike
40	Nishant Kaushik	CTO at Uniken and veteran identity technologist with 20+ years in IAM product innovation. Prolific inventor with multiple patents. Serves on advisory boards for Identiverse and RSA Conference.	linkedin.com/in/nishantkaushik
41	Pamela Dingle	Director of Identity Standards at Microsoft driving development of OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, FIDO, and SCIM. Founding member of Women in Identity and leading advocate for open collaboration.	linkedin.com/in/pameladingle
42	Philip Hoyer	IAM expert and security industry veteran focused on passwordless authentication, phishing-resistant MFA, and regulatory compliance. Regular speaker at cybersecurity leadership events.	linkedin.com/in/philiphoyer
43	Pieter Kasselmann	Co-chair of the IETF WIMSE working group focusing on securing machine identities across multi-cloud environments. Expert in SPIFFE, OAuth, and workload identity standards.	linkedin.com/in/pieter-kasselmann
44	Rebecca (Becky) Archambault	Leads Trusted Identities at Highmark Health defining identity strategies across workforce, consumer, and partner ecosystems. Chairs the H-ISAC Identity Committee and founded the WNY Identities Working Group.	linkedin.com/in/rebecca-archambault
45	Sean Deuby	Identity and directory services expert with 30+ years in enterprise and hybrid identity. Microsoft MVP, advisor at Semperis, and respected author focused on Active Directory and identity resilience.	linkedin.com/in/seandeuby
46	Sebastian Rohr	Known as the "IdentiBeer Guy," an IAM and compliance expert recognised for deep technical expertise and business acumen. Helps enterprises align identity, governance, and regulatory frameworks.	linkedin.com/in/sebastianrohr
47	Simon Moffatt	IAM innovator, author, and founder of The Cyber Hut. Provides actionable research and advisory for identity and access security, simplifying digital identity, governance, and Zero Trust	linkedin.com/in/simonmoffatt

		adoption.	
48	Steve Wilson	Principal digital safety analyst at Constellation Research and founder of the Lockstep Group. Australian digital identity and privacy consultancy expert shaping identity strategy in APAC.	linkedin.com/in/lockstep
49	Steven Rennick	Veteran IT and identity professional with 25+ years of experience spanning desktop support to enterprise architecture. Specialises in NHI, authentication/authorisation, and Zero Trust. Member of The Identity Underground.	linkedin.com/in/steven-rennick
50	Vittorio Bertocci (in memoriam)	Legendary identity architect at Auth0/Okta and Microsoft. Co-authored RFC 9470 (OAuth Step Up Authentication). Created the Identity, Unlocked podcast. His educational contributions permanently raised the identity industry's IQ.	linkedin.com/in/vittoriobertocci

Key Communities, Podcasts, and Platforms to Follow

Beyond individual thought leaders, the following communities and platforms are essential resources for identity professionals:

Table E.2 — Identity Communities and Resources

Resource	Description	URL
IDPro	The professional association for digital identity practitioners. Publishes the Body of Knowledge (BoK) that underpins the CIDPro certification.	idpro.org
The Identity Underground	Exclusive global network of CXOs and practitioners focused on identity security innovation, led by Jessica Stone.	theidentityunderground.com
NHI Management Group	The leading research and advisory group on non-human identity risks, founded by Lalit Choda. Offers NHI Foundation training.	nhimg.org
Identity at the Center Podcast	Hosted by Jeff Steadman and Jim McDonald. Explores digital identity, IAM, cloud, and cybersecurity with industry leaders.	identityatthecenter.com
Identity Jedi Podcast	Hosted by David Lee. Engaging conversations on identity, access, trust, and the human side of IAM.	identityjedi.com
Identerati Office Hours	Hosted by Mike Schwartz. Live show discussing identity standards, open source, and the future of IAM.	gluu.org
Women in Identity	Global non-profit promoting diversity and inclusion in the identity industry. Networking, mentoring, and events for identity professionals.	womeninidentity.org
Identity Management Institute	Professional body offering identity certifications (CIAM, CIGE, CIMP, CIPA, CIRM, CRFS). Founded by Henry Bagdasarian.	identitymanagementinstitute.org
KuppingerCole Events	European Identity Conference (EIC), cyberevolution, and Identity Fabric Impact Day. Premier events for identity professionals globally.	kuppingercole.com/events
Identiverse Conference	The identity industry's flagship annual conference bringing together practitioners, vendors, and standards architects.	identiverse.com
FIDO Alliance	The industry consortium developing FIDO2, WebAuthn, and passkey standards for passwordless authentication worldwide.	fidoalliance.org
Cloud Security Alliance (CSA)	Leading organisation for cloud security best practices, research, and certifications including CCSK. Active IAM working groups.	cloudsecurityalliance.org

Building Your Brand: *The identity community is remarkably welcoming. Start by engaging with content from the professionals listed above, share your own experiences on LinkedIn, contribute to open-source projects, attend conferences (many offer virtual options), and consider writing for the IDPro Body of Knowledge. Your voice matters.*